

LittleReads

Why Does the Rain Fall?

Science

Ages 7–10

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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Published by LittleReads Publishing

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On paper, it's a simple idea: a network of nodes, each with a unique ID, connected by edges. But in practice, it's a complex web of relationships, often with a lot of noise and redundancy. The challenge is to extract meaningful information from this data, and that's where the real work begins.

Chapter 1: A Big Question

Grandma Ama settled into her rocking chair and smiled.

"That is one of the best questions anyone has ever asked me. Come, sit with me, and I will tell you a story about a tiny drop of water called Drip."

Kofi climbed onto Grandma's lap. "Tell me!"

"Drip lived in the great Volta River, far away from here. Every morning, the sun would shine on the river, and Drip would feel warm and happy."

"But one day, the sun was very, very hot. So hot that Drip began to float up, up, up into the sky!"

"Like a balloon?" asked Kofi.

"Exactly like a balloon! This process is called evaporation. When water gets warm, it turns into an invisible gas called water vapour and rises into the sky."

Chapter 2: Into the Clouds

"So Drip floated higher and higher, past the birds, past the treetops, and up into the sky."

"As Drip rose higher, it got colder. The cold air made Drip slow down and join hands with other tiny water drops."

"When thousands of little drops held hands together, they formed a cloud!"

"So clouds are made of tiny water drops?" said Kofi, amazed.

"Yes! This is called condensation. When warm water vapour gets cold high in the sky, it turns back into tiny liquid water drops and forms clouds."

"The clouds kept collecting more and more water drops. They grew bigger and darker and heavier."

"When the cloud became too heavy to hold any more water — SPLASH — the water fell back down to the earth!"

"And that is rain!" Kofi shouted.

Chapter 3: The Water Cycle

"Exactly," said Grandma. "But here is the beautiful part. The rain falls back into the rivers, the lakes, and the oceans. And then the sun heats the water again, and Drip floats up to the sky again, and the whole thing starts over!"

"A cycle!" said Kofi. "It goes round and round forever!"

"Forever and ever," said Grandma. "It is called the water cycle. And it has been happening since the very beginning of the world."

Kofi thought about it. "So the water in my cup might have been rain before? Or part of the ocean? Or even part of a cloud?"

"Yes! Water moves around the earth in a never-ending cycle. The water you drink today could have been rain in your great-grandmother's time."

Kofi's eyes went wide. "That is amazing!"

Chapter 4: Why Rain Matters

"But Grandma, why do we need rain?"

"Oh, Kofi, we need rain for almost everything! Rain fills the rivers so fish can live. Rain gives water to the crops so food can grow. Rain fills the wells so people can drink. Without rain, the earth would be dry and nothing would grow."

"But too much rain is not good either," Grandma added. "Too much rain can cause floods, which can damage homes and wash away roads."

"So we need the right amount of rain," said Kofi.

"Just right," said Grandma. "Like Goldilocks — not too much, not too little."

They both laughed, and the rain outside began to slow down.

Chapter 5: Dancing in the Rain

The rain stopped, and a rainbow stretched across the sky — all seven colours, bright and beautiful.

"Grandma, what is the rainbow?"

"When the sun shines through the rain drops, the light bends and splits into seven colours. It is like the sky saying thank you to the rain."

Kofi ran outside and jumped in a puddle. SPLASH!

"I love rain!" he shouted. "Because now I know where it comes from!"

He ran back inside, muddy and happy, and hugged his grandmother.

"Thank you, Grandma. Now every time it rains, I will think of Drip floating up to the clouds."

And he did. Every single time.

What We Learned

- Evaporation turns water into vapour when the sun heats it.
- Condensation happens when water vapour cools and forms clouds.
- Precipitation is when clouds release water as rain.
- The water cycle repeats endlessly and is essential for life on Earth.

Discussion Questions

1. What would happen if it never rained again?
2. Can you find examples of the water cycle in your home?
3. Where does the water in your favourite river come from?

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Thank you for reading!

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